

A true story? Well, perhaps not. But I expect that most of us know just how that old greyhound felt. How many times have we gone around and around the track, chasing the false rabbit of success, only to discover that the real rabbit was under our nose, waiting to be discovered all along?

Flawed Measures of Wealth . . .

To be clear, I'm not against success. But because there are so many possible definitions of success, I try to avoid using the word whenever possible.²⁴ In bull sessions with my classmates when I was attending Princeton University, the conventional definition of success was said to be achieving wealth, fame, and power. All those years ago, that definition seemed reasonable enough to me, and even though more than a half century has passed since my college days, that definition still seems pretty reasonable. Indeed, the dictionary confirms that definition: "Success: the prosperous achievement of something attempted, the attainment of an object, usually wealth or position, according to one's desire."

So I accept the fact that wealth, fame, and power remain the three main attributes of success, *but not in the conventional way in which we still define those elements*. I have come to recognize that wealth is ill measured by mere dollars, that fame is ill measured by public accolades, and that power is ill measured solely by control over others.

Financial wealth, in fact, is a shallow measure of success. If we accept dollars as our standard, then "money is the measure of the man," and what could be more foolish than that? So how *should* wealth be measured? What about a life well lived? What about a family closely bound by love? Who could be wealthier than a man or woman whose calling provides benefits to mankind, or to his fellow citizens, or to her community or neighborhood?